What to Buy — 81 Cities

The best things to buy in each One Ummah city, and where to buy them.

Source: taken from our own city guides (ALL-81-CITIES.md). Items marked *(to verify)* are not in our guides yet and need checking. Cities with nothing in our guides are listed as **Needs research**. Nothing haram is included.

Signature buys (the 20 best)

Buy	City	Where
Silk carpets	Khiva	Khiva Silk Carpet Workshop
Suzani embroidery, silk scarves	Samarkand	Workshops around the old town
Frankincense and bakhoor	Salalah	Al Haffa Souq
Silver and khanjars	Muscat	Mutrah Souq
Gold jewellery	Dubai	Gold Souk, Deira
Oud, spices, textiles	Doha	Souq Waqif
Hand-stitched bisht	Al Ahsa	Master tailors of Hofuf
Khalas dates	Al Ahsa	Souq Al Khamis (Thursday Market)
Asiri honey	Abha	Local beekeepers, Tuesday Market
Carpets, lamps, ceramics	Istanbul	Grand Bazaar
Silk scarves	Bursa	Koza Han (old silk market)
Hand-hammered copper coffee sets	Sarajevo	Kazandžiluk (coppersmiths' street)
Silver filigree	Prizren	Old-town filigree workshops
Ohrid pearls	Ohrid	Old town shops
Lanterns, perfume oils	Cairo	Khan el-Khalili
Argan oil	Essaouira	Women's cooperatives
Batik and silver	Yogyakarta	Malioboro Street, Kotagede
Chikankari embroidery	Lucknow	Chowk and Aminabad
Lacquer bangles and pearls	Hyderabad	Laad Bazaar, Pathergatti
Shyrdak felt carpets	Bishkek	Local craft shops

Middle East and Gulf

City	Best to buy	Where
Dubai, UAE	Gold, spices, perfume, textiles	Gold, Spice, Perfume and Textile Souks (Deira, Bur Dubai); crafts at Global Village (about Oct–May)
Abu Dhabi, UAE	Local crafts	Heritage Village (Breakwater)
Sharjah, UAE	Carpets, gold, handicrafts, antiques, incense, spices, dates	Central Souq (Blue Souk), Souq Al Arsah, Souq Al Jubail
AlUla, Saudi Arabia	AlUla dates	Date farms in the oasis
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia	Spices, perfumes, fabrics	Souq Al Alawi, Al-Balad
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia	Antiques, carpets, incense	Souq Al Zal
Abha, Saudi Arabia	Asiri honey, herbs, crafts	Tuesday Market (Souq Al Thulatha), local beekeepers
Al Ahsa, Saudi Arabia	Khalas dates, hand-stitched bisht, Al Qarah pottery, spices	Al Qaisariya Souq, Souq Al Khamis
Dammam, Saudi Arabia	Dates, local produce	Qatif markets
Doha, Qatar	Oud, spices, textiles, traditional crafts	Souq Waqif
Muscat, Oman	Silver, khanjars, Omani textiles, luxury perfume	Mutrah Souq, Amouage perfumery

City	Best to buy	Where
Salalah, Oman	Frankincense, bakhoor, incense burners	Al Haffa Souq
Manama, Bahrain	Bahraini halwa	Showaiter, Muharraq old souq
Kuwait City, Kuwait	Dates, spices, perfumes, traditional sweets	Souq Al Mubarakiya
Amman, Jordan	Handicrafts	Rainbow Street, Souk Jara (summer Fridays)
Aqaba, Jordan	Spices, sweets, tax-free goods	Downtown Aqaba
Baku, Azerbaijan	Saffron, spices, homemade jams; carpets *(to verify)*	Taza Bazaar
Ganja, Azerbaijan	Nuts, herbs, pakhlava	Central bazaar

Türkiye

City	Best to buy	Where
Istanbul	Carpets, lamps, ceramics, gold, spices	Grand Bazaar, Spice Bazaar (Eminönü)
Cappadocia (Göreme)	Avanos pottery *(to verify)*	Avanos *(to verify)*
Antalya	**Needs research**	
Bodrum	Spices, textiles; boutique shopping	Weekly bazaar in Bodrum town, Yalıkavak Marina
Pamukkale	Handwoven cotton textiles	Buldan (weaving town)
Fethiye	Spices, textiles, village honey	Tuesday market, Paspatur bazaar
Izmir	General bazaar shopping	Kemeraltı bazaar
Trabzon	Trabzon hasırı (woven silver bracelet), local crafts, tea	Kunduracılar Street, old bazaar; Rize for tea
Bursa	Silk scarves, kestane şekeri (candied chestnuts), İznik tiles	Koza Han, Grand Bazaar; İznik (day trip)
Marmaris	Pine honey (çam balı), spices, leather, textiles	Covered Grand Bazaar
Alanya	**Needs research**	
Konya	Prayer beads, carpets, copperware, Mevlana şekeri	Old bazaar, shops near Rumi's tomb
Ankara	Silverwork, crafts	Beypazarı (day trip), shops inside the citadel

Balkans

City	Best to buy	Where
Kotor, Montenegro	Figs, cheese, olives	Green market outside the Sea Gate
Budva, Montenegro	**Needs research**	
Podgorica, Montenegro	**Needs research**	
Mostar, Bosnia and Herzegovina	Copper, carpets, handmade crafts	Kujundžiluk (old bazaar street)
Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina	Hand-hammered copper coffee sets, rahat lokum	Kazandžiluk, Baščaršija
Ohrid, North Macedonia	Ohrid pearls, handmade paper	Old town, paper workshop near St Sophia
Skopje, North Macedonia	Textiles, spices, household goods	Bezisten (Old Bazaar), Bit Pazar
Tetovo, North Macedonia	Šar mountain cheese, spices	Town market
Tirana, Albania	Olives, cheese, honey; Ottoman bazaar crafts	New Bazaar (Pazari i Ri); Krujë old bazaar (day trip)
Prizren, Kosovo	Silver filigree	Old-town workshops
Pristina, Kosovo	**Needs research** (old bazaar in Peja on a day trip)	

North Africa

City	Best to buy	Where
Marrakesh, Morocco	Spices, black soap; souk crafts	Souk Semmarine, dyers' souk, Mellah spice market
Essaouira, Morocco	Argan oil, amlou (almond-honey-argan spread), spices, olives	Women's cooperatives, central market near Bab Marrakech
Tangier, Morocco	**Needs research**	
Rabat, Morocco	Rugs, leather, handicrafts	Rue des Consuls, medina
Casablanca, Morocco	Modern shopping	Morocco Mall
Cairo, Egypt	Lanterns, spices, perfume oils	Khan el-Khalili
Alexandria, Egypt	Antiques, old furniture, curiosities	Attarine quarter
Sharm El Sheikh, Egypt	Spices, perfume oils, papyrus	Old Market
Hurghada, Egypt	Souk shopping	El Dahar (old town)
Tunis, Tunisia	Perfumes, chechia (traditional red hat)	Souk El Attarine, chechia makers' souk
Djerba, Tunisia	Clay pottery, kilims, woven blankets, fouta towels	Guellala (pottery village), Houmt Souk
Sousse, Tunisia	Spices, ceramics, leatherwork, makroudh pastries	Medina souks, Sunday market; Kairouan for makroudh

Central Asia and Russia

City	Best to buy	Where
Samarkand, Uzbekistan	Suzani embroidery, ceramics, silk scarves; dried fruit, nuts, Samarkand non bread	Old-town workshops, Siab Bazaar
Bukhara, Uzbekistan	Crafts and textiles; Gijduvan ceramics	Trading domes (Toki Sarrafon, Toki Telpak Furushon, Toki Zargaron); Gijduvan (day trip)
Tashkent, Uzbekistan	Spices, dried fruit; art and souvenirs	Chorsu Bazaar, Sayilgoh Street
Khiva, Uzbekistan	Silk carpets	Khiva Silk Carpet Workshop, covered bazaar
Almaty, Kazakhstan	Dried fruit, honey	Green Bazaar, Zhibek Zholy
Astana, Kazakhstan	**Needs research** (malls such as Khan Shatyr)	
Turkistan, Kazakhstan	Kazakh crafts, felt souvenirs, dried fruit, kurt	Near the Karavan Saray, local bazaar
Shymkent, Kazakhstan	Spices, fruit	City bazaars
Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan	Shyrdak felt carpets, honey, nuts	Craft shops, Alamedin Bazaar, Dordoi Bazaar
Dushanbe, Tajikistan	Dried fruit, nuts, spices	Mehrgon Market
Kazan, Russia	Chak-chak (Tatar honey sweet)	Chak-Chak Museum area, Old Tatar Quarter

Southeast and South Asia

City	Best to buy	Where
Bali, Indonesia	Art and crafts	Ubud Art Market
Yogyakarta, Indonesia	Batik, silver, bakpia pastries	Malioboro Street, Kotagede, Pathuk
Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia	Batik, songket, crafts; sarees, spices	Central Market (Pasar Seni), Brickfields
Penang, Malaysia	Spices, saris	Little India, Batu Ferringhi night market
Langkawi, Malaysia	Chocolates, cookware (duty-free)	Kuah duty-free stores
Malé, Maldives	Lacquerwork, woven mats	Chaandhanee Magu, Majeedhee Magu
Baa Atoll, Maldives	**Needs research**	
Hunza Valley, Pakistan	Dried apricots, gemstones, handwoven woollens	Karimabad bazaar
Skardu, Pakistan	Dried apricots, nuts, gemstones	Skardu bazaar
Satun, Thailand	Night-market goods	Satun town night market

City	Best to buy	Where
Koh Lanta, Thailand	**Needs research**	
Kozhikode, India	Kozhikode halwa, spices	S.M. Street, Valiyangadi market
Lakshadweep, India	Coconut and coir crafts	Island craft centres *(to verify)*
Hyderabad, India	Lacquer bangles, Hyderabad pearls	Laad Bazaar, Pathergatti
Lucknow, India	Chikankari embroidery	Chowk, Aminabad

East Africa

City	Best to buy	Where
Zanzibar City (Stone Town), Tanzania	Spices (cloves, nutmeg, vanilla, cinnamon)	Spice farms, Darajani Market

Needs research (9 cities)

Antalya · Alanya · Budva · Podgorica · Pristina · Tangier · Astana · Baa Atoll · Koh Lanta, plus checking the *(to verify)* items in Baku, Cappadocia and Lakshadweep.

Note

Gold and silk are fine to buy as gifts or for women. In Islam, men don't wear gold or silk.